Business Summary — Sugar Cosmetics Instagram Performance

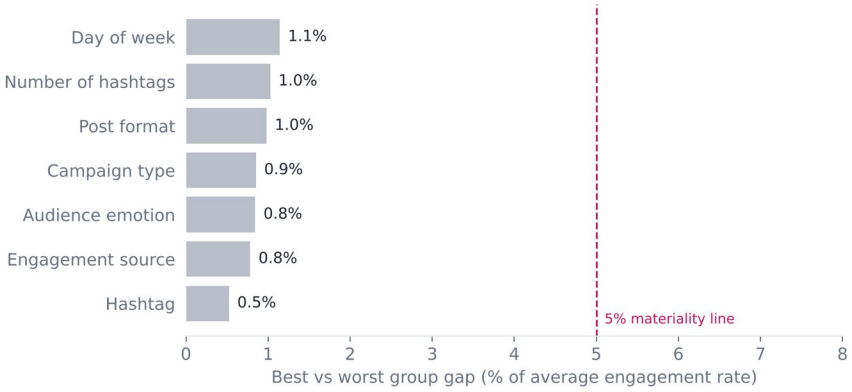
Executive brief for the marketing team · 19 Apr 2024 – 19 Apr 2025 · 50,000 post-level records

Bottom line. Instagram performance is healthy and steady, but none of the seven levers tested — format, weekday, campaign, audience emotion, source, hashtag and hashtag count — is a proven winner (gaps of only 0.5–1.1%). Growth will come from more reach, deeper engagement and better follower conversion, not from re-allocating effort between formats.

50,000	987.42M	147.73M	18.46M	18.54%
Posts (records)	Total reach	Likes	Comments	Avg engagement

What we found

- **Performance is consistent.** Posting is steady at about 4,100 records a month and engagement rate stays near 18.5% every month.
- **No format is a clear winner.** Reel (18.61%), Story, Video and Image are within 0.18 points; the difference is not statistically significant.
- **No proven best day or hashtag.** Wednesday (18.63%) edges Sunday (18.42%); hashtags differ by 0.10 points. Both are within noise.
- **Reach, not format, drives volume.** Likes track reach closely (r = 0.79); engagement rate does not (r = 0.00).
- **Most interaction is shallow.** Likes are 81% of interactions; comments, saves and shares together are 19%.
- **Audience and source do not matter much either.** Curious (18.62%) and Excited (18.47%) differ by 0.16 points; paid, organic, influencer and collab posts perform alike.
- **Audience growth has a clear funnel.** 3.0% of reach visits the profile and 30% of visitors follow — about 8.87M follows in the year, ~740K a month.
- **One signal worth testing.** Posts with 2 hashtags score 18.63% vs 18.44% for 1 hashtag — borderline significant (p = 0.05).
- **A fixable gap exists.** 6.2% of records (3,117) were widely seen but earned little engagement.



What to do next

1. **Scale reach** through influencer collabs and boosting the strongest creatives.
2. **Rescue high-reach, low-engagement posts** with stronger hooks and clear calls-to-action.
3. **Build save- and share-worthy content** — tutorials, festive offers, challenges — to move beyond likes.
4. **Optimise the profile** (bio, highlights, link-in-bio) to lift follow conversion.
5. **Run 4-week A/B tests** starting with hashtag count (2 vs 1/3), then format and posting time, before changing the content mix.
6. **Capture richer data** (post ID, caption, posting hour, ad spend, follower count).

> **Data note.** The dataset has no captions or post IDs and shows about 137 records per day with unusually flat distributions, which suggests synthetic or aggregated data. Treat these results as a validated framework and confirm them on the brand's live Instagram Insights export.